

Kharavela of Chedi dynasty was the king of Kalinga, present in Odisha, India. Much of the available information about Kharavela comes from the Hathigumpha inscription. He is believed to be a follower of Jainism.

9. **Kaling king Kharavel was related to-**

- (a) Mahameghavahan Dynasty
- (b) Chedi Dynasty
- (c) Satavahan Dynasty
- (d) Rath-Bhojak Dynasty
- (e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (e)

The founder of the Chedi dynasty of Kalinga was a person named Mahameghavahana. Therefore the name of this dynasty also became the Mahameghavahana dynasty. The most powerful ruler of this dynasty was Kharavela. The Hathigumpha inscription is the only means of studying Kharavela's history.

Gupta and Post-Gupta Period

1. **Which Gupta ruler assumed the throne after killing his elder brother?**

- (a) Shri Gupta
- (b) Samudragupta
- (c) Chandragupta II
- (d) Skandagupta
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (c)

After Samudragupta, his son Ramagupta become the ruler, but He was not able to oppose the invasion of Shaka, his brother Chandragupta II Killed Ramagupta and married his wife Dhruv Devi and won against Shaka.

2. **Who is called 'the Napoleon of Ancient India'?**

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya
- (b) Pushyamitra
- (c) Kanishka
- (d) Samudragupta

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

Historian V.A. Smith in his composition 'The Early History of India' called Samudragupta (335-375 A.D.) of Gupta dynasty as 'Napoleon of India' for his great military conquests.

3. **According to Chinese source, Meghavarman, the ruler of Sri Lanka, sent a missionary to which of the following Gupta Kings for permission to build a Buddhist temple at Gaya?**

- (a) Chandragupta I
- (b) Samudragupta

- (c) Chandragupta II
- (d) None of them

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Meghavarman sent a missionary to Samudragupta to build a Buddhist temple at Gaya. Samudragupta granted permission to Buddhist king of Ceylon (Sri Lanka) Meghavarman to build a monastery at Bodh Gaya.

4. **The Gupta emperor who defeated the 'Hunas' was:**

- (a) Samudragupta
- (b) Chandragupta- II
- (c) Skandagupta
- (d) Ramagupta

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

The first invasion of Hunas took place during the reign of Skandagupta and Hunas were comprehensively defeated by him. This invasion was just like a raid, and there was not lasting impact on India, but this invasion intensified the decline of the Gupta Empire. Hunas annexed many regions of the north-west in the transition period of the 5th-6th centuries after the death of Skandagupta.

5. **Which one of the following ports was in use for the north Indian trade during the Gupta period?**

- (a) Kalyan
- (b) Tamralipti
- (c) Broach
- (d) Cambay
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (e)

During the Gupta period Tamralipti of Bengal was an important port that used for trading with South-East Asia, China, Sri Lanka, Java, Sumatra etc. Bhargukatchha (Bharuch) was an important port of western India from where trade of North India with western countries occurred through sea-route. During the Gupta period, most of the Indian trade happened with South-East Asia, hence Tamralipti was most important port of this period. However, Bharuch, Kalyan, Cambay etc. were also used for North Indian trade. Hence most suitable answer would be more than one which is option (e).

6. **Which Gupta ruler is mentioned as 'Param Bhagawata' in Nalanda Copper Plates?**

- (a) Chandragupta I
- (b) Chandragupta II
- (c) Samudragupta
- (d) Skandagupta
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

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Ans. (c)

Copper plate inscription of Samudragupta from Nalanda and Gaya describes Param Bhagavata title of Samudragupta.

7. In pre-Gupta times, a large number of lead coins were issued by the

- (a) Satavahanas (b) Shakas
- (c) Kushanas (d) Mauryas
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

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Ans. (a)

The Satavahanas were the early rulers of the region between the rivers, Godavari and the Krishna. They were also referred to as the Andhras. They soon brought under their control, both the Western-Deccan and Central India. Their coins were pre-dominantly of copper and lead, however, silver issues are also known. These coins carried the motifs of fauna like elephants, lions, bulls, horses etc. after juxtaposed against motifs from nature like hills, trees etc. The silver coins of the Satavahanas carried portraits and bilingual legends which were inspired by the Kshatrapa type.

8. Who among the following is known for his work on medicine during the Gupta period?

- (a) Sushruta (b) Saumilla
- (c) Shudraka (d) Shaunaka
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (e)

Sushruta is called the father of surgery. He was a resident of Kashi. It is believed that his period was around 600 B.C. Shaunak was the sage of the Rigveda. Shudraka was a dramatist of the Gupta period (litterateur). Saumilla is a playwright of Gupta period who has been remembered by Kalidasa with Bhasa and Kaviputra. Thus, none of the above had worked in the field of medicine during the Gupta period. Although Bihar Public Service Commission in its initial answer sheet has considered the correct answer as option (a). Since the Gupta period begins with 275-A.D. (Sri Gupta), which is about 875 years later than the valid period of Sushruta (usually 600 BC), it is not reasonable to consider Sushruta a contemporary of the Gupta period.

9. The gradual decline of towns was an important feature of which period?

- (a) Gupta period
- (b) Pratihara era
- (c) Rashtrakut
- (d) Satavahana era

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

During the Gupta period, towns declined gradually. All the towns which were prosperous in the valley, most of them had declined in that age. A major city, Patliputra became village when Hiuen-Tsang came to India. Mathura, Sonpur, and Sohagama- all major cities provided evidence of a decline in this age. So, we can say that the gradual decline of towns is an important feature of the Gupta period.

10. Which ruling dynasty donated maximum villages to temples and Brahmins?

- (a) Gupta Dynasty (b) Pala Dynasty
- (c) Rashtrakuta (d) Pratihara

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

The ruler of Gupta dynasty donated a maximum number of villages to temples and Brahmins. Also, the income generated from the land of the village used to be given to the owner of the land.

11. What was the land revenue rate in Gupta age?

- (a) Fourth part of the production
- (b) Sixth part of the production
- (c) Eighth part of the production
- (d) Half part of the production

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

A person who used to cultivate on the official land of the ruler had to pay a part of crop-products as tax in Gupta period which was the sixth portion of the production. Land revenue is known as 'Udrang' and "Bhag" in Gupta inscriptions.

12. What is the land revenue rate in religious books?

- (a) 1/3 (b) 1/4
- (c) 1/6 (d) 1/8

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

In every religious text, the land revenue rate is 1/6th of the produce.

13. Which type of land was called 'Aprahat'?

- (a) Without cultivated forest land.
- (b) Irrigated land.
- (c) Dense forest land.
- (d) Cultivated land.
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Uncultivable lands were called 'Aprahat'. It was a term of the revenue system in the Gupta period.

14. Chinese traveller 'Sungyun' was came to India in:

- (a) 515 AD to 520 AD (b) 525 AD to 529 AD
- (c) 545 AD to 552 AD (d) 592 AD to 597 AD
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (e)

Chinese traveller 'Sungyun' came to India in about 518 to 521 A.D. He collected texts of Buddha's preaching in his three years of travel.

15. The account of the Moroccan traveller Ibn Battuta is known as

- (a) Rihla (b) Subh-u'l-Asha
- (c) Tarikh-i-Rashidi (d) Riyaz-us-Salatin
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (a)

Ibn Battuta was a Moroccan and Berber explorer. He is known for his extensive travels, accounts of which were published in the Rihla. Rihla was a travel book written by Ibn Battuta in Arabic. He came to India during the regime of Muhammad bin Tughlaq.

16. Which of the following philosophies of India propounded the atom theory?

- (a) Yoga (b) Nyaya
- (c) Sankhya (d) Vaisheshika
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

Maharishi Kanada is associated with atom theory. He was a scientist & philosopher who founded Vaisheshika School of Indian Philosophy in which he gave the atomistic approach to physics and philosophy in Sanskrit.

17. Who has written the 'Harshacharita'?

- (a) Aryabhatta (b) Banabhatta
- (c) Vishnugupta (d) Parimalgupta

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Eminent author Banabhatta composed the text "Harshacharita". This is the major source of Pushyabhuti dynasty. It is a fable in which the author presents the description of his contemporary ruler and biographies of their ancestors.

18. Who laid the foundation of Vardhana Dynasty?

- (a) Pushyabhuti (b) Rajyavardhana
- (c) Adityavardhana (d) Prabhakarvardhana
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (a)

According to Banbhatt's composition 'Harshcharita' the establishment of Vardhan Dynasty was done by a person named Pushyabhuti, in Thaneshwar/Sthaneswar. Harshvardhan was the greatest ruler of this dynasty.

19. Poet Bana was inhabitant of –

- (a) Pataliputra (b) Thanesar
- (c) Bhojpur (d) None of the above

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

Banabhatta, the poet, was born in the village Prithikuta, on the bank of Son River in Aurangabad district (Present Bihar). The names of his father and mother were Chitrabhanu and Rajdevi respectively.

20. Which Chinese traveller visited India during Harshavardhana's rules?

- (a) Fa-Hien (b) Hiuen-Tsang
- (c) I-Tsing (d) Taranath

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

The arrival of Hiuen-Tsang was the most important event of Harsha's period. He desired to visit the places related to Mahatma Buddha and study Buddhist texts, which were available in India. He departed for India in 629 A.D. from Changan, the capital of Tang Ruler. He wrote a book on his tour to India named 'Sei-Yu-Kei.'

21. The famous Chinese pilgrim Fa-Hien visited India during the reign of:

- (a) Chandragupta I (b) Chandragupta II
- (c) Ramagupta (d) Srugupta
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans (b)

Fa-Hien visited India during the reign of Chandragupta-II.

22. Consider the following statements :

1. Fa-Hien was a Chinese pilgrim who visited India during the reign of Harsha.
2. Hiuen Tsang was a Chinese Buddhist monk who visited India during the reign of Chandragupta II.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

Fa-Hien visited India during the reign of Chandragupta II while Hiuen-Tsang visited the court of Harshvardhana. Hence neither statement is correct.

23. During Hiuen-Tsang tour in India most famous city for the production of cotton clothes was:

- (a) Varanasi (b) Mathura
(c) Pataliputra (d) Kanchi

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

The traveller of China Hiuen-Tsang arrived in India during Harsha's period and stayed here. According to Hiuen-Tsang, Mathura was famous for the production of cotton textiles. He also mentioned that the reason for the prosperity of Thanesar was its trade. Ujjayini as well as Kannauj were economically prosperous too.

24. Chinese traveller Hiuen Tsang studied at the University of –

- (a) Taxila (b) Vikramshila
(c) Magadh (d) Nalanda

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

The traveller from China, Hiuen Tsang arrived in India during Harsha's period and went to Nalanda University in 637 A.D. Acharya Sheelbhadra was the Vice-Chancellor of Nalanda University at that time. He learned Yogashashtra there for almost one and a half year. He also delivered a speech during his second visit to Nalanda University.

25. Chinese traveller I-tsing was on the tour of Bihar in about:

- (a) 405 A.D. (b) 635 A.D.
(c) 637 A.D. (d) None of the above

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

With his desire to see the relics of Buddhism, Chinese traveller I-tsing (671-695 A.D.) with his 37 Buddhist associates decided to travel to Western countries. Later his associate left him, and he alone moved to India from Canton city. He came to India through western sea route and returned to China via Sumatra.

26. Nalanda University was destroyed by –

- (a) Muslims (b) Kushans

(c) Scythians

(d) Mughals

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

Nalanda University attracted scholars and students from Tibet, China, Greece and Persia. It was ransacked and destroyed by the army of Bakhtiyar Khalji at the end of the twelfth century. It can be seen as the coup de grace (final blow) to the decline of Buddhism in India.

27. Nalanda Vihar was destroyed by :

- (a) Bakhtiyar Khalji
(b) Qutbuddin Aibak
(c) Muhammad Bin Tughlaq
(d) Alauddin Khalji
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

28. Who was the real founder of Turk rule in Bihar?

- (a) Malik Husarnuddin (b) Bakhtiyar Khalji
(c) Ibrahim (d) Dariya Khan Noohani
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (b)

Bakhtiyar Khalji captured entire Bihar between 1193 A.D. to 1203 A.D. He destroyed Nalanda and Vikramshila Vihar. Later control was also established over some parts of Bengal and Assam. Thus he was the real founder of Turkish power in Bihar.

29. How many rulers of Aryavarta have been mentioned in 21st line of Allahabad Pillar Inscription?

- (a) 6 (b) 7
(c) 8 (d) 9
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

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Ans. (d)

Allahabad Pillar Inscription or the Prayaga Prashasti mentions Samudragupta conquering Nine kings during his second campaign of Aryavarta.

30. Who has argued that the Gupta and post-Gupta periods saw a decline in the money economy?

- (a) R.S. Tripathi
(b) R.S. Sharma
(c) Radha Kumud Mookerjee